

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 38

Making the Jumla Ismiyyah negative

1. Ma al-Hijaziyyah

In Arabic there are two basic kinds of sentence: the *Jumla Ismiyyah* and the *Jumla Fi'liyyah*. The ways of making each negative, and of producing emphasis in each, are different.

Definition: Among the words used to make a *Jumla Ismiyyah* negative, the one used most is *Ma al-Hijaziyyah*. This particle enters both basic parts of the *Jumla Ismiyyah* — the *Mubtada* and the *Khabar* — and changes their grammatical standing.

Before Ma	After Ma
Mubtada (Marfoo')	Ism Ma — stays in its original state of raf'
Khabar (Marfoo')	Khabar Ma — changes from raf' to nasb

زَيْدٌ صَالِحٌ ← مَا زَيْدٌ صَالِحًا

(Zayd is righteous → Zayd is not righteous)

In the first sentence **صَالِحٌ** was *Marfoo'*; in the second **صَالِحًا** has become *Mansoob* on account of *Ma al-Hijaziyyah*.

2. The causes of a noun being Mansoob

In Arabic grammar there are several causes for a noun to be *Mansoob*, that is, to come with a fathah or with a mark standing in its place. Those studied so far are given below.

Cause	Details	Where studied
Ism uz Zarf	words that convey the sense of time or of place	Lectures 33 and 34
Ism of Inna and its sisters	the Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l make their noun Mansoob	Lectures 35, 36 and 37
Khabar of Ma al-Hijaziyyah	when Ma al-Hijaziyyah enters at the head of a Jumla Ismiyyah, its Khabar becomes Mansoob	this lesson

A fine comparison: **إِنَّ** makes its noun *Mansoob* and leaves the *Khabar Marfoo'*. Against this, *Ma al-Hijaziyyah* lets its noun stay *Marfoo'* and makes the *Khabar Mansoob*. That is, the working of the two is the exact reverse of each other.

3. Hadith

قِيلَ لِرَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ: أَيْكُونُ الْمُؤْمِنُ جَبَانًا؟ فَقَالَ: نَعَمْ. فَقِيلَ لَهُ: أَيْكُونُ الْمُؤْمِنُ بَخِيلًا؟ فَقَالَ: نَعَمْ. فَقِيلَ لَهُ: أَيْكُونُ الْمُؤْمِنُ كَذَّابًا؟ فَقَالَ: لَا.

(narrated from Safwan ibn Sulaym, may Allah be pleased with him)

Translation: The Messenger of Allah, peace be upon him, was asked: can a believer be a coward? He said: yes. Then he was asked: can a believer be miserly? He said: yes. Then he was asked: can a believer be a liar? He said: no.

Its relevance to the lesson: It is on the words of this very hadith that the drill of all the forms with *Ma al-Hijaziyyah* is built, as in the table that follows.

4. The table of all the forms

Form	Affirmative (state of raf')	Negative (with Ma al-Hijaziyyah)
singular masculine	الْمُؤْمِنُ كَاذِبٌ	مَا الْمُؤْمِنُ كَاذِبًا
singular feminine	الْمُؤْمِنَةُ كَاذِبَةٌ	مَا الْمُؤْمِنَةُ كَاذِبَةً
dual masculine	الْمُؤْمِنَانِ كَاذِبَانِ	مَا الْمُؤْمِنَانِ كَاذِبَيْنِ
dual feminine	الْمُؤْمِنَتَانِ كَاذِبَتَانِ	مَا الْمُؤْمِنَتَانِ كَاذِبَتَيْنِ
plural masculine	الْمُؤْمِنُونَ كَاذِبُونَ	مَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ كَاذِبِينَ
plural feminine	الْمُؤْمِنَاتُ كَاذِبَاتٌ	مَا الْمُؤْمِنَاتُ كَاذِبَاتٍ

- In the masculine forms the *Khabar* takes the *Tanween* of *nasb*, and in the dual and sound plural it takes the form with a yaa'.
- The *Jam' Salim Mu'annath* كَاذِبَاتٍ has come with a kasrah despite being *Mansoob*, because the *Jam' Salim Mu'annath* takes a kasrah in both the states of *nasb* and *jarr*. This rule was covered in Lectures 35 and 36.

5. Examples from the Qur'an

5.1 Surah Yusuf, verse 31

وَقَالَتْ اخْرُجْ عَلَيْنَهُنَّ فَلَمَّا رَأَيْنَهُ أَكْبَرْنَهُ وَقَطَّعْنَ أَيْدِيَهُنَّ وَقُلْنَ حَاشَ لِلَّهِ مَا هَذَا بَشَرًا

(Surah Yusuf: 31)

Translation: And she said: come out before them. Then when they saw him they were struck with awe and cut their hands, and said: Allah be exalted! This is no human being.

Element	Details
مَا	this is Ma al-Hijaziyyah
هَذَا	an Ism ul Isharah and Mabni; being mahallan Marfoo' it has become the Ism Ma
بَشَرًا	it stands in the state of nasb and is the Khabar Ma

5.2 Surah al-Mujadilah, verse 2

الَّذِينَ يُظْهِرُونَ مِنْكُمْ مَنْ نَسَاهُمْ مَا هُنَّ أُمَّهَاتِهِمْ

(Surah al-Mujadilah: 2)

Translation: Those among you who pronounce zihar against their wives — they are not their mothers.

Element	Details
مَا	this is Ma al-Hijaziyyah
هُنَّ	a detached pronoun, which being mahallan Marfoo' has become the Ism Ma
أُمَّهَاتِهِمْ	أُمَّهَاتِ is Mansoob with a kasrah for being a Jam' Salim Mu'annath, and the Mudaf with its Mudaf Ilayh together form the Khabar Ma

6. The Ba Za'idah — emphasis in a negative sentence

Rule: When a *Jumla Ismiyyah* is made negative by *Ma al-Hijaziyyah*, the particle **بِ** is entered upon its Khabar to produce further emphasis, weight and firmness in that negation. This is called the *Ba Za'idah* — the additional ba.

By the rules, after the *Ba Za'idah* enters, the *Khabar* changes in wording from *Mansoob* to *Majroor*. But in meaning it is not rendered like "with" or any other *Harf ul Jarr*. It comes only to produce the emphatic sense of "not at all" or "by no means" in the sentence.

Plain negation	With the Ba Za'idah
مَا زَيْدٌ صَالِحًا	مَا زَيْدٌ بِصَالِحٍ
Zayd is not righteous	Zayd is not righteous at all · Zayd is by no means righteous

Here the *Ba Za'idah* has produced intensity and emphasis in the negation.

Qur'anic examples of the Ba Za'idah

وَمَا اللَّهُ بِغَافِلٍ عَمَّا تَعْمَلُونَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 149)

Translation: And Allah is not at all unaware of what you do.

Element	Details
اللَّهُ	the Ism Ma
بِ	an additional Harf ul Jarr, for emphasis
غَافِلٍ	the Khabar Ma

وَمَا هُمْ بِمُؤْمِنِينَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 8)

Translation: And they are by no means believers.

Element	Details
هُمْ	the Ism Ma
بِ	an additional Harf ul Jarr, for emphasis
مُؤْمِنِينَ	the Khabar Ma

وَمَا صَاحِبُكُمْ بِمَجْنُونٍ

(Surah at-Takwir: 22)

Translation: And your companion, peace be upon him, is by no means mad.

Element	Details
صَاحِبُكُمْ	the Mudaf with its Mudaf Ilayh together form the Ism Ma
بِ	the Ba Za'idah
مَجْنُونٍ	the Khabar Ma

وَمَا هُوَ عَلَى الْغَيْبِ بِضَنِينٍ

(Surah at-Takwir: 24)

Translation: And he is not withholding of the unseen.

Element	Details
هُوَ	a pronoun, which is the Ism Ma
عَلَى الْغَيْبِ	a jarr with its majroor, related to the Khabar, that is, the Muta'alliq ul Khabar
بِ	the Ba Za'idah
ضَنِينٍ	the Khabar Ma

وَمَا هُوَ بِقَوْلِ شَيْطَانٍ رَجِيمٍ

(Surah at-Takwir: 25)

Translation: And it is not the word of an accursed devil.

Element	Details
هُوَ	a pronoun, which is the Ism Ma
بِ	the Ba Za'idah, on account of which the Mudaf قَوْلِ became Majroor
قَوْلِ شَيْطَانٍ رَجِيمٍ	the Mudaf, with its Mudaf Ilayh and that noun's Sifah, together form the Khabar Ma

7. Ma and La, the two likened to Laysa

In Arabic two particles are used to make a *Jumla Ismiyyah* negative, مَا and لَا, which in the terminology of grammar are called **مَا وَلَا الْمُشَبَّهَتَانِ بِلَيْسَ** — "the ma and the la that are likened to laysa".

What is Laysa?: لَيْسَ is a *Fi'l Naqis* that enters a *Jumla Ismiyyah*, makes its *Khabar Mansoob*, and gives the sense of negation. Since مَا and لَا do the very same work, they have been declared like لَيْسَ.

Two differences between Ma and La

- In the Qur'an لَا is not used with this particular grammatical working, while مَا is found in abundance.
- The *Ba Za'idah* enters the *Khabar* of مَا but does not enter the *Khabar* of لَا.

Why is it called Hijaziyyah?

The case of this particle was not the same in the dialects of the different Arab tribes, and it is from that its name arose.

Dialect	Its working	The form
The people of Hijaz	they hold Ma to be working like Laysa, so the Khabar becomes Mansoob	مَا زَيْدٌ صَالِحًا
The tribe of Tamim	they hold Ma to be non-working, so the Khabar stays in its original state of raf'	مَا زَيْدٌ صَالِح

The conclusion: Since the Qur'an was revealed according to the **speech of Hijaz**, in which the *Khabar* becomes *Mansoob*, it is this that is called *Ma al-Hijaziyyah*, and it is this rule that is needed for understanding the Qur'an.

A condition on the working of Ma

Ma al-Hijaziyyah does its work only when **إِلَّا** does not come between the noun and the *Khabar*. If the particle of exception comes between them, the working of مَا ends and the *Khabar* becomes *Marfoo'* once more.

مَا هَذَا إِلَّا بَشَرٌ مِّثْلُكُمْ

(Surah al-Mu'minun: 24)

Translation: This is not but a man like you.

Here بَشَرٌ is *Marfoo'* and not *Mansoob* — because **إِلَّا** came between and broke the working of مَا. Compare it with the verse of Surah Yusuf, مَا هَذَا بَشَرًا, where, there being no **إِلَّا**, the *Khabar* came *Mansoob*.

8. The degrees of emphasis in speech

The degrees of emphasis in speech may be raised according to the denial or doubt of the listener. In a negative *Jumla Ismiyyah* there are three basic stages.

Stage	The form	The sentence	Translation
1	plain negation	مَا زَيْدٌ صَالِحًا	Zayd is not righteous
2	with the Ba Za'idah	مَا زَيْدٌ بِصَالِحٍ	Zayd is not righteous at all
3	an oath together with the Ba Za'idah	وَاللَّهِ مَا زَيْدٌ بِصَالِحٍ	by Allah, Zayd is not in the least righteous

9. A rhetorical analysis of Surah al-Qalam

At the opening of Surah al-Qalam, in answer to the insistence and severe denial of the disbelievers, Allah gathered together all the highest styles of emphasis.

ن وَالْقَلَمِ وَمَا يَسْطُرُونَ ﴿١﴾ مَا أَنْتَ بِنِعْمَةٍ رَبِّكَ بِمَجْنُونٍ ﴿٢﴾

(Surah al-Qalam: 1 to 2)

Translation: Nun. By the pen and what they inscribe. You are not, by the favour of your Lord, mad at all.

The three aspects of emphasis

Aspect	Details
The majesty of the divine speech	the speaker is the Creator of the universe Himself, and His speech is in itself wholly true and emphatic
The use of an oath	through ن وَالْقَلَمِ وَمَا يَسْطُرُونَ an oath is sworn by the pen and by what is written with it
The use of the Ba Za'idah	by entering the Ba Za'idah upon بِمَجْنُونٍ, madness was negated of the Prophet, peace be upon him, decisively and finally

The difference between the two ba's

In this single passage the letter ba has come twice, and the standing of the two is entirely different.

Where	Which ba	Its grammatical standing
بِنِعْمَةِ رَبِّكَ	an original Harf ul Jarr	the jarr with its majroor together form the Muta'alliq ul Khabar, and it is rendered "by the favour of"
بِمَجْنُونٍ	the Ba Za'idah	it enters the Khabar Ma and produces emphasis in the negation; it has no separate rendering of its own

Hence the rendering: "You are not, by the favour of your Lord, mad **at all**." The first ba gave "by the favour of", and the second gave "at all". That is the difference between the two ba's.

Summary

1. The ways of making a Jumla Ismiyyah and a Jumla Fi'liyyah negative, and of emphasising each, are different.
2. The word used most to make a Jumla Ismiyyah negative is Ma al-Hijaziyyah.
3. After Ma al-Hijaziyyah enters, the Mubtada is called the Ism Ma and stays in its original state of raf'.
4. The Khabar is called the Khabar Ma, and Ma al-Hijaziyyah changes it from the state of raf' to that of nasb.
5. From **رَزِيْدٌ صَالِحٌ** came **مَا رَزِيْدٌ صَالِحًا**, where **صَالِحًا** became Mansoob on account of Ma.
6. The causes of a noun being Mansoob include the Ism uz Zarf, the Ism of Inna and its sisters, and the Khabar of Ma al-Hijaziyyah.
7. Inna makes its noun Mansoob and leaves the Khabar Marfoo', while Ma al-Hijaziyyah works the exact reverse.
8. In the masculine forms the Khabar takes the Tanween of nasb, and in the dual and sound plural the form with a yaa'.
9. The Jam' Salim Mu'annath comes with a kasrah despite being Mansoob, as in **كَادِبَاتٍ**.
10. In the verse of Surah Yusuf, **مَا هَذَا بَشَرًا هَذَا** is the mahallan Marfoo' Ism Ma and **بَشَرًا** the Mansoob Khabar Ma.
11. In the verse of Surah al-Mujadilah, **مَا هُنَّ أُمَّهَاتُهُمْ هُنَّ** is the Ism Ma and **أُمَّهَاتُهُمْ** the Khabar Ma.
12. To produce further emphasis in a negative sentence, the Ba Za'idah is entered upon the Khabar.
13. After the Ba Za'idah the Khabar becomes Majroor in wording, but it is given no separate rendering in meaning.
14. It comes only to produce the emphatic sense of "not at all" or "by no means".
15. From **مَا رَزِيْدٌ صَالِحًا** came **مَا رَزِيْدٌ بِصَالِحٍ**, and intensity entered the negation.
16. Ma and La are called the two likened to Laysa, because they do the very work that Laysa does.
17. Laysa is a Fi'l Naqis that enters a Jumla Ismiyyah, makes its Khabar Mansoob, and gives the sense of negation.
18. In the Qur'an La is not used with this working, while Ma is found in abundance.
19. The Ba Za'idah enters the Khabar of Ma but not the Khabar of La.
20. The people of Hijaz hold Ma to be working and make the Khabar Mansoob, while the tribe of Tamim hold it to be non-working.
21. The Qur'an was revealed according to the speech of Hijaz, which is why it is called Ma al-Hijaziyyah.
22. If **إِلَّا** comes between the noun and the Khabar, the working of Ma ends and the Khabar becomes Marfoo'.
23. There are three degrees of emphasis: plain negation, negation with the Ba Za'idah, and an oath together with the Ba Za'idah.

24. At the opening of Surah al-Qalam all three highest styles of emphasis are gathered: the majesty of the divine speech, an oath, and the Ba Za'idah.
25. In that passage there are two ba's: an original Harf ul Jarr in بِنْعَمَةِ رَبِّكَ, and the Ba Za'idah in بِمَجْنُونٍ.

Exercise

1. Define Ma al-Hijaziyyah and state what effect it has upon the Mubtada and the Khabar.
 2. State separately the state of l'raab of the Ism Ma and the Khabar Ma.
 3. Write all three causes of a noun being Mansoob.
 4. What is the difference between the working of Inna and that of Ma al-Hijaziyyah?
 5. Form the affirmative and negative sentences of all six forms with the word كَاذِبٌ.
 6. Why does the Jam' Salim Mu'annath come with a kasrah despite being Mansoob?
 7. Give a full analysis of مَا هَذَا بَشَرًا.
 8. Separate the Ism Ma and the Khabar Ma in مَا هُنَّ أُمَّهَاتُهُمْ.
 9. What is the Ba Za'idah and for what purpose is it brought?
 10. What effect does the Ba Za'idah have upon the state of l'raab of the Khabar?
 11. Write four Qur'anic examples of the Ba Za'idah and analyse each.
 12. What is meant by the two likened to Laysa?
 13. Define Laysa and state why Ma and La were declared like it.
 14. Write both differences between Ma and La.
 15. Why is Ma al-Hijaziyyah called Hijaziyyah?
 16. Explain with an example the difference between the dialects of Hijaz and of Tamim.
 17. What is the condition on the working of Ma? Explain with the example containing إِلَّا.
 18. Write all three degrees of emphasis with examples.
 19. State all three aspects of emphasis in the opening verses of Surah al-Qalam.
 20. Explain the difference between the two ba's occurring in that passage.
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سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ